Diabetes

Diabetes is a disease that occurs when your blood glucose, also called blood sugar, is too high. Over time, having too much glucose in your blood can cause other health problems such as heart disease, nerve damage, eye problems, and kidney disease. You can take steps to prevent or manage diabetes.

According to the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention's *National Diabetes Statistics Report*, an estimated 38.4 million people in the United States, or 11.6% of the population, have diabetes. About 1 in 5 adults with diabetes don't know they have the disease. An estimated 97.6 million American adults have prediabetes, which means their blood glucose levels are higher than normal but not high enough to be diagnosed as diabetes.

Digestive Diseases

The digestive system made up of the gastrointestinal tract (GI), liver, pancreas, and gallbladder helps the body digest food. Digestion is important for breaking down food into nutrients, which your body uses for energy, growth, and cell repair.

Some digestive diseases and conditions are acute, lasting only a short time, while others are chronic, or long-lasting.

Kidney Disease

The kidneys are two bean-shaped organs. Each kidney is about the size of a fist. Your kidneys filter extra water and wastes out of your blood and make urine. Kidney disease means your kidneys are damaged and can't filter blood the way they should.

You are at greater risk for kidney disease if you have diabetes or high blood pressure. If you experience kidney failure, treatments include kidney transplant or dialysis. Other kidney problems include acute kidney injury, kidney cysts, kidney stones, and kidney infections.

Liver Disease

The liver has many important functions, including digesting your food and processing and distributing nutrients.

There are many kinds of liver diseases and conditions. Some, like hepatitis, are caused by viruses. Others can be the result of drugs or drinking too much alcohol. Long-lasting injury or scar tissue in the liver can cause cirrhosis. Jaundice, or yellowing of the skin, can be one sign of liver disease.

Weight Management

Obesity is a chronic disease that affects more than one in three adults and about 17 percent of children and adolescents in the United States. More than one in three adults is overweight. Having overweight or obesity increases your risk of type 2 diabetes, heart disease, stroke, fatty liver disease, kidney disease, and other health issues.

If you are struggling with your weight, you may find that a healthy eating plan and regular physical activity help you lose weight and keep it off over the long term.

Urologic Diseases

The urinary tract is your body's drainage system for removing urine. Urine is composed of wastes and water. The urinary tract includes your kidneys, ureters, and bladder. To urinate normally, the urinary tract needs to work together in the correct order.

Urologic diseases or conditions include urinary tract infections, kidney stones, bladder control problems, and prostate problems, among others. Some urologic conditions last only a short time, while others are long-lasting.

Endocrine Diseases

Your endocrine system includes eight major glands throughout your body, such as the thyroid gland, pituitary gland, adrenal gland, and pancreas. This system affects growth and development, metabolism, sexual function, and mood.

If your hormone levels are too high or too low, you may have an endocrine disease or disorder. Endocrine diseases and disorders also occur if your body does not respond to hormones the way it is supposed to.

Diet & Nutrition

Food and beverages provide the energy and nutrients you need to improve health, manage disease, and reduce the risk of disease.

Find resources on nutrition to help you pay attention to what, when, how often, why, and how much you eat and drink, as well as, help manage diseases and conditions such as diabetes, obesity, kidney disease, and others.

Diagnostic Tests

Physicians use a variety of procedures and tests to diagnose diabetes, digestive, kidney, and other diseases and conditions. Information about many of these tests is available below.

Diabetes

- A1C Test and Diabetes

  Defines and explains the A1C diabetes blood test. Discusses using the test for diagnosis of diabetes and prediabetes and monitoring of glucose levels in people with Type 1 or Type 2 diabetes.

- A1C Test and Race/Ethnicity

  Describes hemoglobin variants and how they can cause false results for the A1C test. Discusses how false results can affect diabetes diagnosis and care in people with hemoglobin variants.

- Diabetes and Prediabetes Tests

  Provides a concise summary for health care providers of blood tests for diabetes and prediabetes, covering uses, technical features, and pros and cons of different tests

- Sickle Cell Trait and Other Hemoglobinopathies and Diabetes (For Providers)

  Explains how the A1C test can lead to misdiagnosis, overtreatment, or undertreatment of diabetes in people with hemoglobinopathies. Explains when to suspect a patient has a variant.

Digestive Diseases

- Colonoscopy

  A procedure that uses a long, flexible, narrow tube with a light and tiny camera on one end to look inside your rectum and entire colon. Colonoscopy can show irritated and swollen tissue, ulcers, and polyps.

- Endoscopic Retrograde Cholangiopancreatography

  Describes the purpose of the test, how patients can prepare for it, and what patients can expect during and after the procedure.

- Flexible Sigmoidoscopy

  Describes the purpose of the test, how patients can prepare for it, and what patients can expect during and after the procedure. This publication is also available in Spanish.

- Lower GI Series

  Provides general information about the lower gastrointestinal (GI) x-ray series. Describes the purpose of the test and what patients can expect before, during, and after the procedure. This publication is also available in Spanish.

- Celiac Disease Tests

  Describes tests that identify serological and genetic markers associated with celiac disease. If tests indicate the possibility of celiac disease, a biopsy determines diagnosis.

- Upper GI Endoscopy

A procedure in which a doctor uses an instrument called an endoscope to see the lining of your upper GI tract. Doctors use upper GI endoscopy to find, and sometimes treat, problems in the upper GI tract.

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  Upper gastronintestinal (GI) endoscopy is a procedure in which a doctor uses an instrument called an endoscope to see the lining of your upper GI tract. Doctors use upper GI endoscopy to find, and sometimes treat, problems in the upper GI tract.

- Virtual Colonoscopy

  Provides information about virtual colonoscopy. Describes the purpose of the test, how patients can prepare for it, and what patients can expect during and after the procedure.

Endocrine Diseases

- Thyroid Tests

  Describes the different tests used to evaluate thyroid function and diagnose thyroid disease. Includes typical thyroid test results seen in thyroid diseases.

Kidney Disease

- Kidney Biopsy

  Describes the procedure and possible reasons for performing this diagnostic test. Outlines the preparations for and explains what patients can expect during and after the test.

Liver Disease

- Liver Biopsy

  Provides general information about liver biopsy. Describes the purpose of the test, how patients can prepare for it, and what patients can expect during and after the procedure.

Urologic Diseases

- Cystoscopy and Ureteroscopy

  Outlines possible reasons for cystoscopy and ureteroscopy and explains the preparations involved. Describes the procedures in detail, as well as what patients can expect afterward.

- Urinary Tract Imaging

  Explains the range of imaging technologies used to evaluate the urinary tract, including ultrasound, conventional radiology, magnetic resonance imaging, and computerized tomography.

- Prostate Tests

  Provides general information about prostate and problems. Describes several tests, including digital rectal exam, PSA blood test, urinalysis, and others.

- Urodynamic Testing

  Describes normal bladder function, as well as problems in the urinary system that may require urodynamic testing. Discusses different urodynamic procedures and why they are used.